

OPERATIONS TEMPLATES

SOP Starter Kit

Eight ready-to-use SOP templates for the
processes every growing business runs on repeat

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Why every recurring task needs an SOP

A standard operating procedure turns a task that lives in one person's head into a process anyone on the team can run consistently. It's the difference between "ask Sarah how we do this" and a system that keeps working when Sarah is on holiday.

This kit gives you a master template plus seven pre-built SOPs for the processes almost every business repeats weekly: meetings, onboarding, task management, communication, and file management.

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TEMPLATE 01

SOP master template

PURPOSE

Use this structure for any process you're documenting for the first time.

HEADER FIELDS

- SOP name
- Owner
- Last updated
- Version number

BODY SECTIONS

- Purpose — why this process exists
- Scope — what it covers and what it doesn't
- Step-by-step instructions, numbered in order
- Tools or systems required
- Who to contact if something goes wrong

REVIEW CADENCE

- Review every SOP at least twice a year, or after any process change.

TEMPLATE 02

Meeting SOP

PURPOSE

Ensure every recurring meeting has an agenda, a purpose, and a documented outcome.

BEFORE THE MEETING

- Send agenda 24 hours in advance
- Confirm required attendees
- Assign a note-taker

DURING THE MEETING

- Start and end on time
- Work through the agenda in order
- Capture decisions and owners as they happen

AFTER THE MEETING

- Share notes within 24 hours
- Log action items in the task tracker
- Confirm next meeting date

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

Weekly leadership meeting: agenda sent Friday, held Monday 9am, notes shared same day with action owners tagged.

TEMPLATE 03

Client onboarding SOP

PURPOSE

Give every new client a consistent, professional first experience.

DAY 1

- Send welcome email with timeline
- Add client to CRM and project system
- Schedule kickoff call

WEEK 1

- Collect required documents and access
- Introduce the team and points of contact
- Confirm goals and success metrics

ONGOING

- Set recurring check-in cadence
- Share reporting schedule and format

TEMPLATE 04

Team onboarding SOP

PURPOSE

Get new hires productive quickly with a consistent first-week structure.

BEFORE DAY 1

- Provision accounts and equipment
- Assign an onboarding buddy
- Prepare a first-week schedule

WEEK 1

- Walk through core SOPs and tools
- Introduce team and reporting lines
- Set 30-60-90 day expectations

30 DAYS

- Check in on progress against expectations
- Gather feedback on the onboarding process itself

Task management SOP

PURPOSE

Keep work visible and moving without relying on memory or side conversations.

CREATING TASKS

- Every task has one owner and one due date
- Tasks live in the system of record, not chat

WORKING TASKS

- Update status as work progresses
- Flag blockers immediately, don't wait for standup

CLOSING TASKS

- Mark complete only when the deliverable is confirmed
- Log any follow-up work as a new task

Communication SOP

PURPOSE

Define which channel to use for what, so nothing important gets lost in the wrong one.

CHANNEL GUIDE

- Urgent and time-sensitive: call or text
- Daily coordination: team chat
- Decisions and records: email or shared doc

RESPONSE EXPECTATIONS

- Chat: same business day
- Email: within 24 hours
- Client messages: within agreed SLA

File management SOP

PURPOSE

Make sure anyone on the team can find the right file without asking.

FOLDER STRUCTURE

- One root folder per client or project
- Consistent subfolders: contracts, deliverables, assets, reports

ACCESS

- Grant access by role, review quarterly
- Remove access immediately on offboarding

VERSION CONTROL

- One current version per file, clearly labelled
- Archive outdated versions, don't delete

Naming conventions guide

Consistent naming makes files and folders searchable without anyone having to remember a system.

CATEGORY	FORMAT	EXAMPLE
Client folders	ClientName_ProjectType	Acme_Rebrand
Working files	YYYYMMDD_FileName_v1	20260727_Proposal_v1
Final deliverables	FileName_FINAL	Proposal_FINAL
SOPs	SOP_ProcessName	SOP_ClientOnboarding

Templates are the start. A system is the goal.

These SOPs cover the essentials. A Summit Operations Blueprint maps every process your business actually needs — and builds the roadmap to document it.

BOOK YOUR OPERATIONS BLUEPRINT

summitvalor.com/blueprint